

PUBLIC SUBMISSION

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Submitter Information

Email: [REDACTED]
Organization: Los Angeles County Business Federation

General Comment

See attached file(s)

Attachments

WHITE HOUSE AI PLAN COMMENT

March 14th, 2025

Mr. Faisal D'Souza
National Coordination Office
2415 Eisenhower Avenue
Alexandria, VA 22314

RE: Office of Science and Technology Policy (OSTP), Networking and Information Technology Research and Development Program (NITRD) National Coordination Office (NCO) and National Science Foundation (NSF) Request for Information concerning AI Action Plan; Los Angeles County Business Federation (BizFed) Comments

Dear Mr. D'Souza:

The Los Angeles County Business Federation (BizFed) submits the following comments to the Networking and Information Technology Research and Development Program National Coordination Office (NITRD NCO) regarding the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan (Plan). BizFed appreciates the opportunity to offer comments and looks forward to working with federal leaders throughout the development of the Plan.

LA County Business Federation (BizFed) Background

The Los Angeles County Business Federation (BizFed) is a powerful, grassroots alliance that unites chambers of commerce, trade associations, minority business groups, economic development organizations, business improvement districts, and other business networks to champion policies and initiatives that strengthen California's economy.

BizFed was founded in 2008 by **Founding Chairman David Fleming** and **Founding CEO Tracy Hernandez** in response to the financial crisis. Their vision was to create a unified, nonpartisan voice for the Southern California business community. Seventeen years later, BizFed has grown into a formidable advocacy powerhouse, representing over **420,000 employers and 5 million employees** across the state. Our coalition includes more than **400 board members** spanning every major industry sector.

BizFed harnesses the power of collective action to explore all sides of critical business issues, ensuring policies are thoroughly vetted before action is taken. BizFed advocates, mobilizes, and educates business leaders on how to effectively engage in the policymaking process. By equipping businesses

with the tools to advocate for themselves, we work to drive economic growth, job creation, and long-term prosperity for California.

We appreciate the administration's commitment to fostering American innovation and ensuring that the United States remains a global leader in technology. The focus on advancing artificial intelligence (AI) while balancing responsible oversight reflects a strong dedication to both economic growth and ethical considerations. BizFed shares the administration's ongoing efforts to support small businesses, recognizing that they are the backbone of our economy and essential to the nation's continued success.

Support for Small Businesses and AI Adoption

With the recent appointment of **Kelly Loeffler** as the 28th Administrator of the U.S. Small Business Administration (SBA) there is renewed optimism for small business advocacy and support.

As AI becomes an integral part of business operations, it is important to ensure that small businesses have the resources to adopt and integrate AI tools effectively. The cost of AI implementation can be a significant barrier, with businesses often facing expenses ranging from **\$5,000 to over \$500,000**, depending on complexity.

To align with the administration's goal of expanding economic opportunity, we encourage the SBA to develop grant programs and educational initiatives that help small businesses leverage AI. Additionally, a federal tax credit for businesses implementing AI could incentivize adoption while ensuring that companies of all sizes remain competitive in an evolving economy.

Need for a National AI Framework

We appreciate the administration's commitment to fairness and inclusion in AI applications. However, BizFed opposes extraneous overregulation on automated decision-making tools (ADMTs) and believes that a cohesive, national framework must be developed at the federal level. AI-driven processes are increasingly shaping hiring, housing, and other critical decisions, making it essential to establish safeguards that prevent bias and discrimination. However, a patchwork of state-by-state regulations would create confusion, increase compliance costs, and stifle innovation. **A national AI framework would provide businesses with the certainty they need to innovate without facing a patchwork of state regulations that could increase compliance costs and create unnecessary burdens.**

The business community is particularly concerned about state-level AI regulations, such as those being proposed in California from a number of agencies, which have been projected, if implemented, could result in significant financial challenges, job losses, and reduced innovation. Furthermore, we encourage federal agencies to clarify the applicability of existing laws to AI technology, minimizing the need for duplicative regulations and ensuring a streamlined and effective approach to innovation and oversight. A unified federal approach would ensure fairness and clarity while maintaining the United States' leadership in AI development.

Investment in AI Education and Cybersecurity

As technology evolves, it is essential to invest in AI education and cybersecurity. By supporting AI-focused curricula in schools, the administration can prepare the next generation for a future in which AI literacy is crucial. Likewise, expanding cybersecurity education and resources for businesses will help safeguard critical infrastructure and sensitive data in an increasingly digital world.

Developing an AI-Skilled Workforce

The demand for AI skills in the U.S. labor market has been steadily rising since [2010](#), with an acceleration in recent years. Approximately **25% of U.S. tech job listings in 2025 require AI skills**, indicating a significant shift in the [job market](#). However, there is a notable skills gap, with **68% of business leaders struggling to attract adequate talent to manage their AI solutions**. Investing in employee development ensures that the workforce is equipped with the latest skills and knowledge, driving companies forward. Leveraging employees' skills to engage in meaningful work may also lead to greater employee satisfaction and retention.

To address this, we recommend the following initiatives:

- **Educational Partnerships:** Collaborate with educational institutions to integrate AI training into curricula, ensuring that students are prepared for the evolving job market.
- **Workforce Development Programs:** Establish programs that provide current workers with opportunities to upskill or reskill in AI technologies, making them more adaptable to technological advancements.

- **Public Awareness Campaigns:** Promote the importance of AI literacy to encourage individuals across various sectors to pursue AI education and training. BizFed has a 501(c)3 arm named the [BizFed Institute](#), BizFed Institute educates, engages and equips business owners with the necessary knowledge, connections and resources needed to create a robust regional economy and strong communities.

By implementing these strategies, we can build a workforce capable of harnessing AI's potential, thereby enhancing productivity and maintaining global competitiveness.

BizFed Pulse Poll

Los Angeles County boasts the largest economy of any county in the nation, serving as a vital engine for the U.S. economy through its diverse industries, including entertainment, manufacturing, and international trade. Each year, BizFed conducts a comprehensive survey of the California business community, gathering critical insights that shape our advocacy efforts. Our recently completed **2025 Pulse Poll**, with input from over **800 business leaders**, highlights the key challenges and opportunities facing businesses today.

If your team would like to schedule a presentation to gain deeper insight into the collective voice of California's business community and its priorities, please contact us at this email.

We would welcome the opportunity to share these findings and collaborate on policies that support economic growth and innovation.

Conclusion

Thank you for your dedication to fostering an environment where businesses can thrive in an AI centered era. We appreciate the administration's continued work in this space and look forward to seeing the impact of a thoughtful and business-friendly AI action plan because business makes the United States work.

Sincerely,

Angela Gibson-Shaw
BizFed 2025 Chair
GLAAACC

David Fleming
BizFed Founding Chair

Tracy Hernandez
BizFed Founding CEO
IMPOWER, Inc.

David Englin
BizFed President

BizFed Association Members

Action Apartment Association
Advanced Medical Technology Association
Alhambra Chamber
American Beverage Association
Antelope Valley Chamber formerly Lancaster Chamber of Commerce
Apartment Association of Greater Los Angeles
Apartment Association of Orange County
Apartment Association, CA Southern Cities, Inc .
Apartment Association of California
Arcadia Association of Realtors
AREAA North Los Angeles SFV SCV
Armenian American Business Association
Armenian Trade & Labor Association
Arts District Los Angeles
ASCM Inland Empire Chapter
Associated Builders & Contractors SoCal (ABC SoCal)
Associated General Contractors
Association of Independent Commercial Producers
AV Edge California
Azusa Chamber
Bell Chamber
Beverly Hills Chamber
BioCom
Black Business Association
Black Professional Network
Boyle Heights Chamber of Commerce
Bridge Compton Org
Building Industry Association - LA/Ventura Counties
Building Industry Association of Southern California
Building Industry Association- Baldyview
Building Owners & Managers Association of Greater Los Angeles
Burbank Association of Realtors
Burbank Chamber of Commerce
Business and Industry Council for Emergency Planning and Preparedness
Business Resource Group
CalAsian Chamber
CalChamber
California African American Chamber of Commerce
California Apartment Association- Los Angeles
California Asphalt Pavement Association
California Bankers Association
California Black Chamber of Commerce
California Business Properties
California Business Roundtable
California Cleaners Association
California Contract Cities Association
California Council for Environmental & Economic Balance (CCEEB)
California Fuels & Convenience Alliance- Formerly California Independent Oil Marketers Association (CIOMA)
California Gaming Association
California Grocers Association
California Hispanic Chamber
California Hotel & Lodging Association
California Independent Petroleum Association
California Infrastructure Delivery Coalition
California Life Sciences Association
California Manufacturers & Technology Association
California Metals Coalition
California Natural Gas Producers Association
California Restaurant Association
California Retailers Association
California Self Storage Association
California Small Business Alliance
California Travel Association (CalTravel)
California Trucking Association
Californians For Smarter Sustainability
Carson Chamber of Commerce
Carson Dominguez Employers Alliance
Central City Association
Century City Chamber of Commerce

Chatsworth Porter Ranch Chamber of Commerce
Citrus Valley Association of Realtors
Civil Justice Association of California CJAC
Claremont Chamber of Commerce
Commerce Business Council formerly Commercial Industrial Council/Chamber of Commerce
Compton Chamber of Commerce
Compton Community Development Corporation
Compton Entertainment Chamber of Commerce
Construction Industry Air Quality Coalition
Construction Industry Coalition on Water Quality
Council of Infill Builders
Crenshaw Chamber of Commerce
Culver City Chamber of Commerce
Downey Chamber of Commerce
Downtown Alliance
Downtown Long Beach Alliance
DTLA Chamber of Commerce
El Monte/South El Monte Chamber
El Salvador Corridor Association
El Segundo Chamber of Commerce
Employers Group
Energy Independence Now EIN
Engineering Contractor's Association
EXP The Opportunity Engine
FastLink DTLA
Filipino American Chamber of Commerce
Friends of Hollywood Central Park
FuturePorts
Gardena Valley Chamber
Gateway to LA
Glendale Association of Realtors
Glendale Chamber
Glendora Chamber
Greater Antelope Valley AOR
Greater Bakersfield Chamber of Commerce
Greater Coachella Valley Chamber of Commerce
Greater Downey Association of REALTORS
Greater Lakewood Chamber of Commerce
Greater Leimert Park Crenshaw Corridor BID
Greater Los Angeles African American Chamber
Greater Los Angeles Association of Realtors
Greater Los Angeles New Car Dealers Association
Greater San Fernando Valley Chamber
Harbor Association of Industry and Commerce
Harbor Trucking Association
Historic Core BID of Downtown Los Angeles
Hollywood Chamber
Hospital Association of Southern California
Hotel Association of Los Angeles
ICBWA- International Cannabis Women Business Association
Independent Cities Association
Independent Hospitality Coalition
Industrial Environmental Association
Industry Business Council
Inglewood Board of Realtors
Inland Empire Economic Partnership
Irwindale Chamber of Commerce
Kombucha Brewers International
La Cañada Flintridge Chamber
LA County Medical Association
LA Fashion District BID
LA South Chamber of Commerce
Larchmont Boulevard Association
Latin Business Association
Latino Food Industry Association
Latino Golfers Association
Latino Restaurant Association
LAX Coastal Area Chamber
Licensed Adult Residential Care Association- LARCA
Long Beach Area Chamber
Long Beach Economic Partnership
Long Beach Major Arts Consortium
Los Angeles Area Chamber
Los Angeles Economic Development Center
Los Angeles Gateway Chamber of Commerce

Los Angeles Latino Chamber
Los Angeles LGBTQ Chamber of Commerce
Los Angeles Parking Association
Los Angeles Regional Food Bank
MADIA Tech Launch
Malibu Chamber of Commerce
Manhattan Beach Chamber of Commerce
Manhattan Beach Downtown Business & Professional Association
Marina Del Rey Lessees Association
Marketplace Industry Association
Monrovia Chamber
Motion Picture Association of America, Inc.
MoveLA
MultiCultural Business Alliance
NAIOP Southern California Chapter
NAREIT
National Association of Minority Contractors
National Association of Theatre Owners CA/Nevada
National Association of Women Business Owners
National Association of Women Business Owners - LA
National Association of Women Business Owners-California
National Federation of Independent Business Owners California
National Hookah
National Latina Business Women's Association
Norwegian American Chamber of Commerce
Ofiso Community Foundation
Orange County Business Council
Orange County Hispanic Chamber of Commerce
Pacific Merchant Shipping Association
Panorama City Chamber of Commerce
Paramount Chamber of Commerce
Pasadena Chamber
Pasadena Foothills Association of Realtors
PGA
Pharmaceutical Care Management Association
PhRMA
Pico Rivera Chamber of Commerce
Pomona Chamber
Rancho Southeast REALTORS
ReadyNation California
Recording Industry Association of America
Regional CAL Black Chamber, SVF
Regional Hispanic Chambers
San Gabriel Valley Economic Partnership
San Pedro Peninsula Chamber of Commerce
Santa Clarita Valley Chamber
Santa Clarita Valley Economic Development Corp.
Santa Monica Chamber of Commerce
Secure Water Alliance
Sherman Oaks Chamber
Signal Hill Chamber
South Bay Association of Chambers
South Bay Association of Realtors
South Gate Chamber of Commerce
Southern California Contractors Association
Southern California Golf Association
Southern California Grantmakers
Southern California KFC Franchise
Southern California Leadership Council
Southern California Minority Suppliers Development Council Inc.
Southern California Water Coalition
Southland Regional Association of Realtors
Specialty Equipment Market Association
Structural Engineers Association of Southern California
Sunland/Tujunga Chamber
Sunset Strip Business Improvement District
Swiss American Chamber of Commerce
Thai American Chamber of Commerce
The Bridge Network
The LA Coalition for the Economy & Jobs
The Los Angeles Taxpayers Association
The Two Hundred for Homeownership

Torrance Area Chamber
Tri-Counties Association of Realtors
United Chambers – San Fernando Valley & Region
United Contractors
United States-Mexico Chamber
Unmanned Autonomous Vehicle Systems
Association
Urban Business Council
US Green Building Council
US Resiliency Council
Valley Economic Alliance, The
Valley Industry & Commerce Association
Venice Chamber of Commerce
Vermont Slauson Economic Development
Corporation
Veterans in Business
Vietnamese American Chamber
Village of Sherman Oaks BID
Warner Center Association
West Covina Chamber
West Hollywood Chamber
West Hollywood Design District
West Los Angeles Chamber
West San Gabriel Valley Association of Realtors
West Valley/Warner Center Chamber
Westchester BID
Western Electrical Contractors Association
Western Manufactured Housing Association
Western Propane Gas Association
Western States Petroleum Association
Westside Council of Chambers
Westwood Community Council
Whittier Chamber of Commerce
Wilmington Chamber
World Trade Center
Yes in My Backyard
7-Eleven Franchise Owners Association of
Southern California